Anil Sharma : Glad to meet you, too.

Interviewer : What is your first piece of writing that got published?

Anil Sharma : I was 16, when Illustrated Weekly of Media published my first story soon after I left school. It was a funny story about a child.

Interviewer : please tell me something about your parents.

Anil Sharma : My parents are from Himachal Pradesh and there was a great deal of differences in their interests. While one was interested in books, the other was fond of travelling.

Interviewer : Who introduced you to books?

Anil Sharma : During my early childhood, we were in Delhi. My father was very attached to me and spent a lot of time with me. He introduced me to books and films. I was only ten years old when he died. It was a traumatic experience and for two or three years I became a recluse and books were my only companions.

Interviewer : How did you do in your studies?

Anil Sharma : I loved to study English and History but hated Maths. I used to read a lot of books in the school library. You could say I was self-taught.

Interviewer : Did it take long for your first novel, "The Flying Frog" to get published?

Anil Sharma : Yes ! A couple of years. On my mother's suggestion I went to England when I was 17 and took up various jobs there. I would write when I came home in the evenings.

Interviewer : What made you return to India?

Anil Sharma : I missed my friends. I came back purely for emotional reasons.

Interviewer : Did it affect your writing career?

Anil Sharma : I would write four or five short stories and articles every month and send them to magazines and newspapers in the country.

Interviewer : You were making a modest living out of freelancing, weren't you?

Anil Sharma : Well, I did briefly take up jobs. But I wanted to concentrate on my writing.

Interviewer : Why did you settle down in Ooty?

Anil Sharma : I needed peace so that I could write without interruption. I have written many of my best stories there.

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